

TRAINER ONLY - Lab 7 Demo and Answer Key

Project Aurora live SharePoint dashboard: preparation, expected results, demonstration flow and debrief.

DO NOT DISTRIBUTE
This file contains the expected data-quality exceptions, control totals and demonstration answers.

Recommended delivery

Context and capability check	5 min	Explain preview status and confirm the available path.
Create list	10 min	Import the table and verify field types.
Source inspection	10 min	Ask Copilot to find issues before visualisation.
Create and refine report	15 min	Approve the plan, create report and add controls.
Validate	10 min	Compare dashboard with the control workbook.
One-field test	10 min	Change IT-017 Amber to Red and confirm only expected deltas.
Debrief	10 min	Challenge conclusions and discuss governance.

Capability check

- Copilot in SharePoint is a preview capability and requires an active Microsoft Copilot license.
- Availability can be controlled for the tenant or selected sites.
- If unavailable, demonstrate from an enabled tenant or use prepared screenshots and the reference dashboard.
- Do not ask participants to manually rebuild the HTML report.

Expected control totals before IT-017 changes

Control	Count/Value
Total projects	30
Active projects	27
Red	3
Amber	13
Green	13
Missing RAG	1
Over budget	16
Forecast late	16
Stale	2
Decision required	15
Records with quality flags	10
Approved budget	EUR 6,925,000
Forecast cost	EUR 6,912,000
Reported variance	EUR -31,000
Calculated variance	EUR -13,000

FINANCIAL TRAP

The portfolio appears forecast under budget because IT-018 contains an invalid negative forecast cost. IT-003 and IT-029 also contain incorrect reported variance values. Do not allow the dashboard to present the aggregate as trusted.

Expected quality findings

IT ID	Issue	Impact
IT-003	Variance says EUR 5k; calculation is EUR 10k	A reported field can conflict with source values.
IT-006	Red but Decision Required = No	Status does not automatically create a decision.
IT-009	Project manager blank	Do not infer ownership from sponsor or department.
IT-012	Decision required but owner blank	Decision remains Not confirmed.
IT-015	Green with 45-day delay	RAG and schedule can conflict.
IT-018	Negative forecast and missing evidence	Aggregate budget is unsafe.
IT-021	Last update 25 Jul	Stale data weakens the dashboard.
IT-027	Forecast go-live blank; evidence missing	Missing date must remain visible.
IT-029	Variance says EUR 8k; calculation is EUR 21k	Second reconciliation test.
IT-030	Blank RAG, stale update, missing evidence	Blank categories need explicit treatment.

Expected dashboard structure

- Header: Project Aurora Portfolio Health, source list and as-of date.
- KPI cards: active, Red, over budget, forecast late, stale, decisions required.
- Filters: department, project manager, stage, RAG and decision required.
- Visuals: RAG distribution, stage distribution, budget versus forecast, schedule variance.
- Searchable exception table with source-item links.
- Visible quality-warning area and Not confirmed treatment.

What to reject

- A dashboard plan that excludes blank RAG records without disclosure.
- A calculated RAG that overwrites the supplied RAG field.
- Automatic correction of IT-003, IT-018 or IT-029.
- A conclusion that the portfolio is under budget without qualifying invalid data.
- An invented project manager or decision owner.
- A report that is based on copied values instead of the SharePoint list.

One-field test answer

Item name	Current	Target	Delta
IT-017 RAG	Amber	Red	One field
Red projects	3	4	+1
Amber projects	13	12	-1
Green projects	13	13	0
Total projects	30	30	0
Over budget	16	16	0
Forecast late	16	16	0
Decision required	15	15	0
Approved budget	EUR 6,925,000	EUR 6,925,000	0

Debrief answers

Question	Expected Answer
Why is the report useful?	It makes the current list easier to explore and can stay connected to the underlying source.
Why is it not enough?	It inherits source quality, field definitions, permissions and missing evidence.
Why use a one-field test?	It proves whether the connection and calculations respond predictably without unrelated changes.
Why keep RAG and schedule separate?	RAG is a supplied business status; a late date is evidence, not automatic authority to overwrite it.
Why not repair financial errors automatically?	A project owner or finance controller must confirm the authoritative values.
When should Power BI be used?	For governed semantic models, advanced calculations, enterprise distribution, row-level security and mature BI lifecycle needs.

Trainer fallback

- Show the official preview prerequisite and explain why the capability can be absent.
- Demonstrate the enabled experience or show prepared screens.
- Open the interactive example at the end of the GitHub lab.
- Have participants inspect the supplied source and validation workbook.
- Run the reasoning and one-field impact prompts even if report creation is unavailable.
- Do not replace the feature with manual HTML authoring.

Sources

- Video: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AYqTGLgzgV4>
- Copilot in SharePoint preview: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/copilot-in-sharepoint-get-started>
- August 2026 update: <https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/blog/spblog/whats-new-in-copilot-in-sharepoint-august-2026/4535421>
- Create a list: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/lists/data-and-lists/create-a-list>
- List thresholds: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/lists/data-and-lists/list-view-threshold-for-large-lists-and-libraries>